



laid the foundation for its existence. Parkesine and Bakelite are some of the early developments in the field while a number of synthetically altered natural substances (chewing gum, for example) were coming into use.

Plastic's biggest advantage is its non-biodegradability which made it a strong contender for use as wrappers and containers. Various materials in the group with more strength and durability found their use in other areas such as electric and heat insulation. Plastic is extremely resistant to corrosion and can be easily molded into any desirable shape and hence qualifies for a cheap alternative to many household objects such as plates, pipes, furniture etc.

Given its reusability and cheaper cost of production, it's easy to see why there's so much of it around us. Since the material is comparatively harder to decompose, the method of recycling it is the key to a cleaner, greener planet. The improper ways by which plastic is disposed has vilified it as an anti-nature product.

Propeller

A type of fan that transmits power by converting rotational motion into thrust, a propeller is used by both, ships as well as planes. Propellers work by creating a pressure difference between the forward and rear surfaces of the airfoil-shaped blade and a fluid such as air or water is accelerated behind the blade. Invented by Josef Ressel in 1827, his ship 'Civetta' was the first ship to be successfully driven by a propeller.

Amongst aircrafts, the Wright brothers pioneered the twisted airfoil